8 A. H. Longhurst, *The Buddhist antiquities of Nagarjunakonda*, Madras Presidency, 1938. In his report Longhurst also commented that 'the ruthless manner in which all the buildings at Nagarjunakonda have been destroyed is simply appalling. This cannot represent the work of treasure-seekers alone since so many pillars, statues, and sculptures have been wantonly smashed to pieces.'

9 From Li Rongxi's translation of 'The Life of Nagarjuna Bodhisattva Translated from the Chinese of Kumarajava', *BDK English Tripitaka 76-III, IV, V, VI, VII Lives of great monks and nuns*, 2002.

10 See Stephen Batchelor, *Verses from the Center: a Buddhist Vision of the Sublime*, 2000. Nagarjuna's teaching was built around the twin concepts of *sunyata,* or 'emptiness', referring to the 'emptiness' of inherent existence, and *Pratiyasamutpada*, or 'dependent origination', the chain of causes which result in the endless cycle of rebirth and suffering, but which can be broken by attaining liberation and nirvana. No less important is his clarification of the 'two truths' doctrine in the Buddha's teaching, the idea that there is *samvrti satya,* 'superficial truth', and *paramartha satya*, 'ultimate truth', the latter being that all is emptiness. In Batchelor's words: 'To experience emptiness is not a descent into an abyss of nothingness but a recovery of the freedom to configure oneself as an intentional, unimpeded trajectory through the shifting, ambiguous sands of life.' Batchelor writes: 'Nagarjuna's *Mulamadhyamakakarika* served as a catalyst to trigger the chain of events that was to revolutionize Buddhist tradition … He opened up the possibility of tradition being animated as much by contemporary voices as by reference to ancient discourses and encyclopaedia. The key to Nagarjuna's *Verses* lies in his understanding of emptiness as inseparable from the utter contingency of